

In my (Jill's) work with clients in the mental health field, this is often a go-to category for finding stability. Routines can be implemented quickly and easily and are actions we can make toward our goals and needs. We all love some fast and effective action steps!

Consider the rhythms that are helpful to the life you're cultivating. The patterns you engage in and the ways they can aid your efforts toward "less complicated." Like looking at your income and expenses with each payday and making adjustments as needed. Or negotiating your bills biannually. Or setting financial goals with each new year. Weaving relevant and helpful routines into your already established life can keep a good thing going for the long run.

From there, a great way to simplify routines is to automate! Thanks to technology, we can make singular decisions by using automation to our advantage, cut out decision fatigue and cumbersome tasks, and friggin move on with the rest of our lives. This is an especially important concept to adopt when we begin implementing a plan with our money. From bills to retirement investing, we'll say it again: automate it! Rely less on your memory and availability, and put good money decisions on autopilot.

Simplifying Your Spending

When I (Jill) was a freshman in college, my roommate went to study abroad for a month. With no accountability and only one class, I went a little feral. I was hanging out with friends, playing pranks, and sleeping on floors, and I let dirty clothes pile up so high that I had a hard time opening the door. I would literally crawl over it all, dig to the bed, and fall asleep. At one point I made brownies in the communal kitchen and slid the leftover tray (uncovered) under the door of my room so I could rush off to my next spontaneous activity. It all culminated in an ant infestation. And not just a trail of ants making their way to the brownies, no. I'm talkin' ants covering the floor like a pulsating blanket of insects. I was horrified. Thankfullky, my fast-paced, no-rule lifestyle stopped once both pest control and my roommate showed up. I quickly found an equilibrium that involved renewed hygiene practices and a more rigorous class schedule. I learned the hard way that my nineteen-year-old brain needed structure and accountability.